

Early Product Strategy

Early Traction, Product-Market fit, Prioritization

A little about me:

- Started my career in visual design & front-end development
- Self taught UX & Research
- 1st Interaction Designer at Modcloth
- 1 of 4 first Principal UX at The Nerdery
- UXPA Past President
- Podcast Host, Speaker, Facilitator, Mentor
- Co-founder/CEO formerly at Aurelius
- AI Strategist at Blank Metal

The Aurelius Journey

1. The Idea
2. Building a Product vs. Building a Business
3. You are not your customer (even when you are)
4. Great Product $\neq$ Great Business
5. Joining an Accelerator
6. Growing & Scaling
7. Exit

The Idea

UX & Customer Research is critical for making the best products and services, but it wasn't scaling well.

Surely there's a better way to solve this than just throwing more people at it?

Building a Product vs. Building a Business

Original idea for Aurelius was a 50/50 model of SaaS + Services

A great product alone does not make a great business

Feedback, Feedback, Feedback

Start marketing your product before it's done*

**No, I'm not kidding*

You are not your customer (even when you are)

Aurelius was built intentionally for UX Researchers...something I knew a little about....right?

“I wish we could work this way, but we’re not mature enough yet”

Signals, behavior, pain points, workflow

Great Product ≠ Great Business

Getting initial traction

First product launch, beta, paying customers

Feedback, Feedback, Feedback

Building Too Much Too Soon

Aurelius began as full product strategy platform

UX Research synthesis and management was only a part of that

Early customers and industry signal forced us to change

Established Product - Major Feature Redesign

Note-taking features core to the platform

Very high effort to redesign & rebuild

Don't wait too long

Ruthlessly prioritize for your business and customer

Growing & Scaling

Speed is Critical, but...

“Fast is fine, but accuracy is final. You must learn to be slow in a hurry” - Wyatt Earp

Product Marketing, Finding a “Flywheel”, Building a Community

Where to Invest (Time, Money, Energy, Resources)

“Operationalize” Your Business & Processes